

The same order data — why does it have three answers?

689 CNY

add every record

440 CNY

paid only

390 CNY

paid minus refunds

All three numbers can be calculated. What is missing is the rule: what counts, how refunds are handled, and which time to use.

One dataset, three calculations

Six public synthetic orders. Region comes from joining the customers table.

Order	Region	Amount	Status
O001	East China	120.00	paid
O002	South China	80.50	paid
O003	East China	50.00	refunded
O004	East China	199.00	pending
O005	South China	60.00	paid
O006	East China	320.00	paid

A · add all records

120 + 50 + 199 + 320

689 CNY

B · paid only

120 + 320

440 CNY

C · paid minus refunded

120 + 320 – 50

390 CNY

The formula is easy; the rule is still in everyone's head

One request can silently turn into three different business rules.

ONE REQUEST

Report order amounts by region

Business

Include pending orders

689

Analyst

Look at paid only

440

Finance

Subtract refunds

390

THE QUESTION LEFT BEHIND

Who is wrong? Where is the evidence? Which rule should we use next time?

Make the business meaning clear before delivery starts

- 01 Bring the sources in and say what you need to understand
- 02 The Agent finds evidence and asks about rules that can change the result
- 03 A person confirms the key rules and leaves a reviewable candidate definition

Agent finds evidence · people confirm business facts

Tell it which sources to use this time

Set the boundary first, so the Agent knows what this round can rely on.

数契

SOURCES

orders.csv

customers.csv

notes.md

CURRENT PROGRESS

Start with one question

1 Set goal 2 Understand 3 Clarify 4 Organize

3 sources are in this round

Orders, customers and notes enter this analysis together.

ContextOx Agent

What do you want to understand from these three sources?

I want to report order amounts by region.

Send

The Agent asks the questions that can change the result

It does not guess business facts. Each question explains why it needs an answer now.

ALREADY FOUND IN THE SOURCES

Order status: paid, refunded, pending

Join: customer_id

Time: paid_at

01

Should pending orders count?

Changes the East China 199 CNY

population

02

How should refunds be handled?

Excluding vs subtracting changes the answer

amount rule

03

Which time assigns the order?

Payment time changes the time window

time window

A person makes the decision in plain language

The Agent organizes answers into rules; a person checks them before the next round.

AWAITING CONFIRMATION

I organized your answers into 3 rules

After confirmation, update

Net order amount by region

Order-customer relationship

Which orders count

Count paid orders only

Pending does not enter the amount

How refunds are handled

Subtract from original region

Treat refunded as a deduction

Which time to use

Assign by payment time

Pending orders have no payment time

Confirm & continue

After the answers, the definition really changes

390 CNY illustrates the rule difference; the product stops at a candidate definition.

UPDATED THIS ROUND

Net order amount by region

Aggregate paid amounts by customer region, then subtract refunds from that same region.

1 candidate field

1 candidate relationship

3 confirmed rules

Included records	status = paid	Confirmed
Refund handling	Subtract from original region	Confirmed
Time assignment	paid_at · China Standard Time	Confirmed
Source relationship	orders.customer_id = customers.customer_id	Evidence linked

notes.md · line 7: inclusion, refunds and time need business confirmation

What remains is more than an AI reply

A new owner can see where the conclusion came from and what is still open.

01

Sources this round

3 public synthetic files

02

Why we asked

Choices that change the result

03

Who decided

Human answer and c
onfirmation

04

What changed

Fields, relationships and rules

05

Still unknown

Open items stay visible

Review without guessing again

Evidence, answers and changes can be traced through the same record

Different tools solve different stages

ContextOx focuses on the stage where the business definition is still unclear.

What you want to do	Better-fit tool	ContextOx's place
Complete coding, research or making work	General Agent, such as Codex	Hand execution to it once the definition is clear
Build catalogs, lineage, permissions and context	Atlan, DataHub	Connect later; do not rebuild the data foundation
Ask questions on an existing semantic model	BI and data-question tools	ContextOx handles the step before the rule is settled
One request has several possible meanings	ContextOx focus today	Find gaps, ask a person, leave a reviewable definition
ContextOx's current bet	Keep the human decision, evidence and unknowns in one candidate definition.	

What it can do now—and what it cannot

YOU CAN TRY NOW

Have a continuous Agent conversation

No complex run concepts first

Set the source boundary

Use only selected sources

Ask about and confirm rules

Human decisions stay explicit

Review candidates and evidence

Changes and unknowns stay visible

DO NOT INTERPRET IT AS

A candidate is a formal approval

Key definitions still need review

A production database writer

The Demo does not run SQL or writes

Cloud multi-user collaboration

Workspace and state stay local

Validated customer value

Engineering checks do not replace outcomes

Bring a business definition that never quite matches, and make it clear with ContextOx

Start with the public synthetic example, or bring a redacted set of sources for one round.

Discuss a question or request a trial

GitHub contact

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Public source · public synthetic Demo · candidate results checked by people

github.com/archerthegoat/contextox-agent